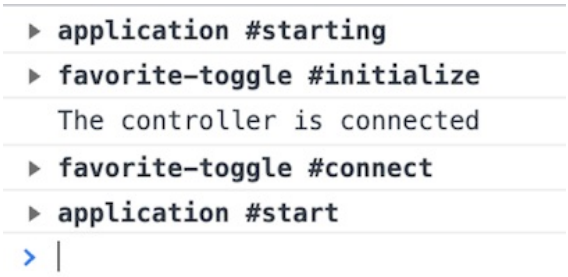
The :void is our first part of TypeScript-specific syntax and just tells TypeScript that the connect method doesn't return a value. (TypeScript can actually figure that out for itself, but it prevents some errors if you get in the habit of specifying whether or not you expect a return value in the function declaration.)

Okay, reload the page and look at the browser console. You'll see that the message has been printed to the console. If you go into the controllers/application.js file and change application.debug = true, you'll get a few more lines of debug data as shown in the screenshot.



This tells us that the application has started, that our controller has initialized and connected, and when startup is over. Each of these lines can be pulled down for more context (for example the exact element the controller has connected to). You can reset application.debug = false now, if you'd like.

The Stimulus library searches the DOM for data-controller attributes, and every time it finds one, it attempts to find a matching controller for it using the name of the controller to find the matching file. This is true no matter when the DOM is changed; Stimulus connects on initial page load, and it also recognizes DOM changes once the page has loaded, no matter what the source of the change is.

It's worth making a couple of points here that aren't necessarily important now, but are worth keeping in the back of your mind because of the way they will inform how we structure Stimulus code going forward.

First, you can declare the same controller an arbitrary number of times in a single document. Declaring the same controller name over and over again will give you separate instances of the same controller. You can even have the same controller nested inside itself: